

Luxemburg

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1. Study Courses That Qualify (Claude)

The "student" residence status covers full-time higher education: a non-EU student coming to a higher education establishment in Luxembourg to follow, as a main activity, a full-time course of study leading to a higher education qualification awarded by that establishment. This also extends to doctoral researchers: a researcher in doctoral training is also considered a "student." The course must be your **main, full-time activity** — part-time or distance study generally won't qualify you for this residence category. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

2. Embassy/Consulate Appointment

Luxembourg's process is mostly **paper/mail-based for the first step**, not appointment-driven like some countries. The future third-country student must send a request for temporary authorisation to stay (on plain paper) from their country of origin: to the Directorate General of Immigration, or to a diplomatic or consular representation of Luxembourg. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

Only if you also need an entry visa (Type D) do you then go to the consulate: for people subject to a visa requirement to enter Luxembourg, after obtaining the temporary residence authorisation, you must request a Type D visa. At that stage, you'd contact your local Luxembourg embassy/consulate (or the nearest one representing Luxembourg) to book the visa appointment — this varies by country, so checking with your specific consulate is the practical next step once your temporary authorization is approved. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

3. Steps to Apply for a Study Visa

The process has two distinct stages:

Stage 1 — Before entering Luxembourg:

A third-country national who wants to settle in Luxembourg for more than 3 months for study purposes must follow a procedure made up of 2 consecutive steps: 1st step: before entering the territory: request a temporary residence authorisation from the Directorate General of Immigration of the Ministry of Home Affairs. If you need a visa to enter, you then apply for the Type D visa. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

Critically: the request must be submitted and granted before entering the territory. A request submitted while already in the territory will be declared inadmissible.

[Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

Stage 2 — After entering Luxembourg:

make a declaration of arrival with your new commune of residence in Luxembourg. From there you proceed to get your actual residence permit (titre de séjour) card.

[Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

Documents needed: passport copy, proof of acceptance at a recognized institution, proof of sufficient financial resources, and (if applicable) a copy of a residence permit from another EU state.

How long it takes: Official processing times aren't published as a fixed number on guichet.public.lu in the material I found, but the temporary authorization is explicitly time-limited once granted: in case of agreement, the third-country national obtains a "temporary residence authorisation." This temporary residence authorisation will be valid for a period of 90 days. Within that 90-day window you must either get your visa or, if visa-exempt, enter and register with your commune. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

4. Documents to Prepare

For the temporary authorization request, you need: a copy of the entire valid passport; where applicable, a copy of the residence permit from another EU member state if residing there, plus your acceptance letter and **proof of sufficient financial resources, Proof of admission to a higher education institution, proof of health insurance. And parental consent for minors.** (detailed in Question 5). [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

5. Money Requirements

Luxembourg ties the financial threshold to its **social inclusion income (REVIS)** rate, not a flat figure: the monthly resources must correspond to at least 80% of the current amount of the social inclusion income in force in Luxembourg. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

As a concrete reference point from an official form: monthly resources must correspond to at least €1,161.60 (80% of the current amount of the social inclusion income in Luxembourg) — though this is regularly adjusted, so always check the live figure on guichet.public.lu before applying. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

You can prove this through: the original of a scholarship or student loan certificate indicating the amount granted and its duration, or, if your parents are supporting you, justifying sufficient resources on the part of the student's parents and showing that the parents are solvent and able to finance their stay costs, including study and health costs, for at least one academic year via a signed sponsorship declaration (attestation de prise en charge). [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)[Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

Helpfully, part-time work income and free housing also count toward this threshold: in assessing resources, material benefits available to the applicant are also taken into

account, such as free housing, as well as income from salaried activity of a maximum duration of 15 hours per week carried out by the person concerned. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

6. Applying for a Residence Permit After Arrival

Once in Luxembourg, after your commune arrival declaration, your residence permit (titre de séjour) is issued. The validity period of the residence permit runs from the date of the arrival declaration at the commune. As long as the conditions for obtaining it remain met, the residence permit is renewable upon request. The student residence permit is valid for a minimum of 1 year, or for the duration of the course cycle only, if that is shorter. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

7. Working While Studying

Yes, with a capped limit: the student is authorised to carry out a salaried activity limited to a maximum average duration of 15 hours per week over a one-month period, outside of time devoted to studies. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

This is calculated as a **monthly average**, not a strict weekly cap: the weekly duration cannot exceed an average of 15 hours over a period of one month or 4 weeks, for a total of 60 hours. So you could work more in one week and less in another, as long as the monthly total stays at or below 60 hours. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

Since the standard permit covers a full year (or the length of the study cycle if shorter), most students will need to renew at least once for longer programmes. The residence permit is renewable upon request, provided you still meet the original conditions (enrollment, financial resources, etc.). The renewal application follows a similar documentary logic to the initial application — proof of continued enrollment, updated proof of financial resources (the same REVIS-linked threshold), and a sponsorship letter if parents are still supporting you. A specific "Engagement de prise en charge" (sponsorship declaration) form for either the initial application or renewal is available on guichet.public.lu. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)[Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

9. Changing to a Work Permit After Studies

Yes, Luxembourg has a dedicated pathway, but it's reserved for **Master's graduates and PhD holders** — not all students:

A third-country student may continue to stay in Luxembourg for jobseeking or business-creation purposes only if: they have successfully completed their final higher education diploma leading to a Master's degree; or they have successfully defended their doctoral thesis for research work in Luxembourg. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.lu)

Timing matters: the request for a residence permit for jobseeking or business creation must be made at the latest 30 days before the expiry date of the student residence permit or the end of the mobility period. And if you find a job: the request for a residence permit as a salaried or self-employed worker must also be made before the expiry of the student residence permit. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.public.lu)

There's a fee involved: issuance of a residence permit for jobseeking or business creation purposes can only happen if the person has paid an issuance fee of €80. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.public.lu)

Financially, you must still show resources during this jobseeking period: the monthly resources must correspond to at least €1,161.60 (80% of the current social inclusion income amount) to cover living costs without relying on social assistance. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.public.lu)

Important caveat: this jobseeking/transition route is explicitly for Master's and PhD-level graduates. If you're finishing a Bachelor's, the pathways are more limited — it's worth confirming your specific options directly with the Directorate General of Immigration based on your exact qualification level.

10. Official Government Information

The authoritative source is **guichet.public.lu** — the official Luxembourg government citizen-services portal — specifically its Immigration section covering residence permits for third-country nationals (students, jobseekers, workers). The relevant authority behind these procedures is the **Direction générale de l'Immigration** (Directorate General of Immigration) within the Ministry of Home Affairs (Ministère des Affaires intérieures).

11. Official Application Forms

Official forms are hosted directly on guichet.public.lu as downloadable PDFs, organized by procedure, for example:

- Initial student residence authorization request and explanatory notes
- Student residence permit renewal request
- "Engagement de prise en charge" (financial sponsorship declaration) form for parents/guarantors
- Post-studies jobseeking/business-creation residence permit request

These are found under the site's "Catalogue de formulaires" (form catalogue) in the Immigration > third-country nationals > student section.

12. Common Mistakes & Tips

- **Applying from inside Luxembourg** — this is an automatic rejection: a request submitted while already in the territory will be declared inadmissible. You must apply from your home country, before travel. [Guichet.lu](https://guichet.public.lu)
- **Missing the 90-day window** — once your temporary authorization is granted, you only have 90 days to either get your entry visa or enter and register at your commune, so don't delay.
- **Underestimating the financial proof threshold** — since it's tied to the REVIS rate (which adjusts periodically), using an outdated figure from a blog or old document can lead to a shortfall. Always verify the current amount on guichet.public.lu directly.
- **Sponsor documentation gaps** — if parents are financing your studies, the sponsorship declaration needs to cover a full academic year of costs (study, health, and return travel) and follow the specific legal format — using the official template form avoids rejection on technical grounds.
- **Exceeding the 15-hour/60-hour work limit** — because it's a monthly average, students sometimes miscalculate by thinking weekly; track your total hours over the 4-week period, not just week to week.
- **Missing the 30-day pre-expiry deadline** for the post-study jobseeking permit — this is a hard cutoff before your student permit expires, so plan well ahead of your graduation date.

1. Study Courses (Gemini)

To apply for a study visa in Luxembourg, **a non-EU student must be enrolled as a full-time student in a higher education program.** Eligible courses include:

Non-EU students must be enrolled in a full-time study programme in a higher education institution(including doctoral studies) or participating in a student exchange programme to come to Luxembourg as a student.

- Degrees offered by the **University of Luxembourg** (Bachelor's, Master's, or PhD programs).
- Programs leading to an Advanced Technician's Certificate (**Brevet de Technicien Supérieur – BTS**).
- Programs at accredited private higher education institutions established in Luxembourg.

- Official student exchange programs covered by bilateral or European agreements.

2. Embassy Appointment

Luxembourg requires a two-step application. First, you must receive approval directly from the Ministry of Home Affairs in Luxembourg. Only after receiving that approval do you book an embassy appointment.

- Once your **Temporary Authorisation to Stay (AST)** is approved, you must apply for a **Type D Visa** within 90 days.
- You can book this appointment by contacting the nearest **Luxembourg Diplomatic Mission or Consulate** in your country of residence, or a mission representing Luxembourg (often the Belgian or French embassy if Luxembourg does not have an active embassy in your country).

3. Applying for a Study Visa

The application process involves pre-arrival steps and strict timelines:

- **How to Apply:** 1. You must first apply for and receive a **Temporary Authorisation to Stay (AST)** via post or the online *MyGuichet.lu* portal while still outside Luxembourg.
2. Once the AST is granted, submit your **Type D Visa** application at the designated embassy or consulate to allow entry into the country.
- **Documents Needed:** (Detailed in Section 4).
 - **Processing Time:** The processing time for the AST usually takes **several weeks to 3 months**. This is partially correct as the Ministry has a statutory maximum of 3 months. It is critical to apply as soon as you receive your university admission letter (by July 15 for the winter semester or December 8 for the summer semester).

4. Documents Needed

Before traveling, you must prepare these essential documents for your AST and Visa applications:

- A certified full copy of your valid **passport** (all pages).
- An official **Letter of Admission** from an accredited Luxembourg higher education institution.
- A recent, clean **criminal record extract** (police clearance certificate) or sworn affidavit from your country of residence - this is not listed as a required document for the initial AST in official sources
- Proof of comprehensive **health insurance** covering the full period of travel/stay.

- Comprehensive **financial documentation** proving sufficient means.

5. Money Requirements

Luxembourg requires international students to prove they have adequate funds to cover living expenses, tuition, and return travel costs:

- **Minimum Living Allowance:** You must prove you have access to a monthly amount equivalent to **80% of the social inclusion income (REVIS)**. **This amounts to roughly €860.80 per month (approximately €10,330 for a full academic year).** Official source states monthly resources must amount to at least 80% of REVIS, which is significantly higher than €860.80 .
- **Acceptable Formats:** Original certificate of a student grant or scholarship, a bank certificate confirming the funds are held in your name for the last 6 months, or a formal obligation of financial support (sponsorship letter) signed by a guarantor legally living in Luxembourg or parents showing high financial solvency.

6. Residence Permit

After arriving in Luxembourg, the process to get a full residence permit involves three strict steps:

1. **Declaration of Arrival:** Within **3 days** of arriving, you must register at the local commune administration (*Administration Communale*) where you live to get your arrival declaration.
2. **Medical Check:** You must undergo a medical examination by a certified general practitioner in Luxembourg and clear a mandatory tuberculosis screening.
3. **Residence Permit Application:** Within **3 months** of arrival, you must submit your final application for a "Residence Permit for Students" to the Directorate of Immigration, paying an **€80 issuance fee**. This can be completed online via *MyGuichet.lu*.

7. Working While Studying

Yes, non-EU students can work under certain restrictions:

- **During Term Time:** Up to **15 hours per week**.
- **During Holidays:** Up to **40 hours per week** (full-time).
- **Restriction:** Bachelor's degree students are legally **not permitted** to work during their first two semesters of study. - **this is partially correct but should also mention BTS students are subject to the same restriction .**

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

Student residence permits are usually valid for **1 year** or the exact duration of studies if shorter.

- To renew, you must submit an application form (*Demande en renouvellement d'un titre de séjour pour étudiant*) to the Ministry of Home Affairs before your current permit expires.
- You must attach your updated enrollment certificate, transcripts showing good academic progress, updated financial proofs, and pay the €80 fee.

9. Changing to a Work Permit

Upon successfully completing your higher education degree in Luxembourg, you can stay to transition into the workforce:

- **Job Search Extension:** You can apply for a residence permit extension for up to **9 months** to look for employment or start a business relevant to your studies. *However, does not specify that this applies only to Master's and PhD graduates.*
- **Transitioning to Work:** Once you secure an employment contract with a local company, you can apply to change your immigration status to a **Residence Permit for Salaried Workers (Salarié)** - *this is correct but omits the 30-day deadline before permit expiry.*

10. Official Information

Always reference the official state resources for legal and administrative frameworks:

- **Guichet.lu (The Administrative Guide of Luxembourg):** guichet.public.lu
- **University of Luxembourg Immigration Portal:** uni.lu
- **Ministry of Home Affairs / Directorate of Immigration:** gouvernement.lu

11. Application Forms

- Electronic procedures, residence permit submissions, and updates are hosted securely on the national portal **MyGuichet.lu**.
- PDF versions of paper forms can be downloaded directly via the immigration section on the official **Guichet.lu** website under the "Immigration" tab.

12. Tips for Students (Common Mistakes to Avoid)

- **Applying from within the country:** Submitting your initial Temporary Authorisation to Stay (AST) application after arriving in Luxembourg is an automatic ground for rejection. You *must* obtain approval while residing abroad.

- **Missing the 3-day window:** Forgetting to register at the local town hall (commune) within 3 working days of arrival can jeopardize your final residence permit application. Keep your flight ticket and lease agreement handy.
- **Ignoring Translation Rules:** If your documents (like police records or bank certifications) are not in French, German, or English, they must be officially translated by a sworn translator. Missing this step will delay your approval by months.